

@ShopAdonisCares

I Forgot How to Rest.

The burnout recovery reset for the woman
who can't switch off.

This isn't tired. This is burnout.

You sleep and wake up exhausted. You finally sit down — and feel guilty, or restless, or you reach for your phone because doing nothing feels wrong. Somewhere along the way, rest stopped working, and "being busy" became who you are.

That's burnout: not a bad week, but a slow emptying from running on fumes too long. The fix isn't a bubble bath. It's relearning that you're allowed to stop — before your body forces you to.

WHAT THIS IS

A gentle, realistic reset to spot burnout, understand why you can't switch off, and refill the tank with rest that actually restores you.

STEP 1

The burnout check

Tick what's been true lately. This isn't a diagnosis — it's a mirror.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Tired even after a full night's sleep | ☐ Can't relax without guilt |
| ☐ Dreading things I used to enjoy | ☐ Getting sick more often |
| ☐ Snapping at people I love | ☐ Nothing feels fun anymore |
| ☐ Foggy, can't focus or decide | ☐ Resentful of all I "have" to do |
| ☐ Numb / going through the motions | ☐ Relying on caffeine / sugar to function |
| ☐ Cynical or detached | ☐ Fantasizing about everything stopping |

Several of these? You're not weak and you're not failing. You're depleted — and depletion is reversible. Start here, gently.

STEP 2

Why you can't rest

Resting feels impossible for a reason. Circle yours — then question it:

- "If I stop, everything falls apart." (Will it — or will it just be imperfect?)
- "I'll rest when everything's done." (It's never done. That's the trap.)
- "Resting is lazy / selfish." (Says who? Whose voice is that?)
- "Being busy is who I am." (You existed before the to-do list. You still do.)
- "I'll fall behind." (Burnout makes you slower. Rest is the catch-up.)

You learned to earn your worth through doing. You can unlearn it. Your value was never your output.

STEP 3

Micro-rest (you won't take a vacation, so start here)

You don't need a week off you'll never take. You need small, repeatable recovery, today:

- **The 5-minute nothing.** Sit. No phone, no task. Just breathe and stare out a window. Yes, that counts.
- **Real breaks.** Step away from the screen to actually rest — not to do a different chore.
- **Subtract one thing.** Each day, cancel or delegate one item. Lighter beats finished.
- **Single-task.** One thing at a time. Multitasking is a burnout accelerant.
- **Put the phone to bed first.** Scrolling is not rest — it's your brain still working.

My 5-minute nothing will happen at (time/place):

STEP 4

Refill the tank (not just numb it)

Not all "rest" restores you. Some just numbs the exhaustion and leaves you emptier.

Know the difference:

Actually restores

Sleep. A walk outside. Real talk with someone. Sunlight. Moving your body. Making something. Quiet. Water + a real meal.

Just numbs

Doom-scrolling. Bingeing to avoid. Wine to "switch off." Online shopping. Saying yes to fill silence. More caffeine.

One restoring thing I'll trade a numbing one for this week:

Rest is productive.

Read them slowly. Let them sink in:

- I don't have to be useful to be worthy.
- Rest is maintenance, not a reward I earn.
- The world will keep spinning while I sit down.
- An empty woman has nothing left to give anyway.
- Slowing down now is how I avoid breaking down later.

This week I give myself permission to stop:

A self-help tool, not medical advice. If you feel hopeless or unable to cope, please reach out to a professional.

You're allowed to stop before you break.

Five minutes of nothing. One thing off the list. Rest that fills you instead of numbing you. You don't have to earn your way to rest — you just have to let yourself take it.

@ShopAdonisCares